



BAHIR DAR UNIVERSITY
FACULTY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES
DEPARTMENT OF SOCIAL ANTHROPOLOGY
Social Anthropology Mid-Examination for First Year Social Science Students
Exam Weight: 30%

Name: [REDACTED] Time allotted: 40 mins.

IDNO: [REDACTED] Section: 22A

Part One: Write TRUE if the statement is correct or FALSE otherwise (1 point each).

1. Comparative perspective describes anthropology's intention to provide readers with global understanding of diverse human experience. ☒
2. Culture encompasses those elements of people's ways of life acquired through innate learning. ☒
3. The concept of cultural universals is best understood in terms of the need on the part of the society to base adaptation on some innate desires and demands for survival and continuity. ☒
4. Non-material aspects of culture could not be regarded as equally significant as the material aspects of culture. ☒
5. Anthropological perspective cannot be regarded as a tool for development for it emphasizes on cultural preservation. ☒
6. Beliefs are cultural conventions that concern true or false assumptions, specific descriptions of the nature of the universe and humanity's place in it. ☒
7. Cultural relativism states that a culture has to be studied in terms of its own meanings and values. ☒
8. Anthropology is a discipline which is a guardian of only primitive societies and their heritages. ☒

Part Two: Choose the appropriate answer from the alternatives given (1.5 points each).

9. Which attitude towards cultural variations best illustrates a British girl's disregard for French perfume?
A. Cultural relativism B. Ethnocentrism C. Xenocentrism ✓ D. Human Rights
10. Which of the following is not the goal of archeological anthropology?
A. Reconstructing ancient ways of life.
B. Sequencing past material cultures. ✓
C. Classifying ancient objects and artifacts. ✓
D. Examining contemporary ways of life. ✓
11. Which of the following statements is different about cultural anthropology?
A. It anticipates differences in the nature of elements that constitute culture of different societies. ✓
B. It theorizes about similarities in the foundation of the culture of different societies.
C. It recognizes certain facets of culture originating in some regions outweigh others in significance.
D. It assumes the importance of symbols in permitting social interaction among members of a society.
12. Anthropologist Markos has investigated two interacting societies called "xy" and "ab" in order to identify the commonalities found in their culture of funeral; which aspect of socio-cultural anthropology has he applied?
A. Ethnography B. Etic ✓ C. Archaeology ✗ D. Ethnology
13. Which specialized area of physical anthropology studies the evolution of human being through the analysis of human fossil remains?
A. Evolution B. Anthropometry C. Paleoanthropology D. Primatology



14. A society having traditional trivet to prepare their food was vulnerable to smoke related diseases; and the members of that society have experienced change in their material aspect of culture while they have created modern stove. Which culture change process can express this best?
 A. Invention B. Diffusion C. Acculturation D. Globalization
15. For Which concept related to cultural unity and variations that the presence of patrilineal descent rule found in most parts of the world with some societies with matrilineal descent rule could be an example?
 A. Universality B. Generality C. Particularity D. None
16. The tradition of bull-jumping as rite of passage found only in 'Hammer society of Ethiopia' can express concept of _____.
 A. Particularity B. Universality C. Generality D. None

Part Three. Match the items in column "A" with items in column "B" (1 point each).

Column "A"

17. Artifacts ^D
 18. Ecofacts ^E
 19. Archaeological feature ^A
 20. Folkways ^C
 21. Mores ^B

Column "B"

- A. Fireplace
 B. Constitution
 C. Rules concerning hair-cut
 D. Coins
 E. Animal fossil remains

Part 4: fill in the blank space with appropriate answer (1 pt. for each).

22. ^{Set / des. Ans} states that the importance of something for a given society can be expressed in the number of vocabulary found in the language that society does have.
23. _____ aims to investigate and understand the ways of life of ancient people who have been lived before the introduction of writing skill. ^{Pre}
24. _____ is when two cultures trade with, intermarry among, or wage war on one another; and the recipient society experience culture change. ^{Direct diff}
25. _____ considers insiders' views as a primary focus of any anthropological inquiry. ^{Emic}
26. _____ consist of man-made objects such as tools, implements, furniture, automobiles, buildings, dams, roads, bridges, and in fact, the physical substance which has been changed and used by man.

Answer Table

bridges, and in fact, anthropology

Answer Table

Section 22A

Name: [REDACTED]

Id No. [REDACTED]

1. True ✓	9. B ✓	17. D ✓	22. Structural / descriptive linguistic Anthropology
2. True	10. A ✓	18. E ✓	23. Prehistoric Archaeology ✓
3. True ✓	11. D ✓	19. A ✓	24. Direct diffusion ✓
4. False ✓	12. D ✓	20. C ✓	25. Emic ✓
5. False ✓	13. C ✓	21. B ✓	26. material culture ✓
6. True ✓	14. A ✓	5 4	
7. True ✓	15. B ✓		
8. False ✓	16. A ✓		

25/30



Bahir Dar University
Faculty of Social Sciences
Department of social anthropology
Mid Exam for Freshman Students (30%)

Name _____

ID No. _____

Section _____

Time allowed: 45 min.

Part 1: Say 'True' if the statement is correct or 'False' if not (1 pt. each).

1. Literally, "anthropology" can be defined as a study of human being.
2. The broadest scope of anthropology shows the comprehensive coverage of the discipline in both spatial and temporal dimensions.
3. Anthropology gives us an insight into social and cultural diversity, but it fails to help to understand the logic and justification behind group behavior and cultural practices.
4. Culture's integrated feature shows the idea that there are no cultures that remain completely static.
5. Human rights are rights of individuals based on justice and morality; and it supports all of the tenets of cultural relativism.
6. Social Anthropology is not an experimental science in search of law but an interpretive one in search of meaning.
7. The ideational concept of culture entails seeing cultures as sets of ideas that we learn and internalize through shared practice.
8. During its formative years, Anthropology was largely a profession primarily confined in museums.
9. Contemporary Anthropologists mainly studied small communities in technologically simple societies.
10. Contemporary problems such as global warming and socially produced diseases like cancer are examples of maladaptive aspects culture.

Part 2: Choose the Best Answer from the Given Alternatives (1.5 pt. each).

11. Which of the following is considered as material culture:
A. Knowledge and other manifestations of human intellectual achievement
B. The customs and habits of a particular time or people
C. Technologies and tools used by people in everyday life
D. All
12. Ethnographic research in Anthropology involves:
A. Participating in the activities being studied
B. Observing the activities being studied
C. Interacting with people being studied
D. All

Which of the following factors contributed for the development of Anthropology:

- A. Enlightenment B. Evolutionary theory C. Colonialism D. All

14. All of the following are true about Anthropology, *except* —
 A. Anthropology serves as a tool for development
 B. Anthropology helps us to be more sensitive to and appreciative of cultural diversity
 C. Anthropology is confined to study fossil evidences of the proto-humans
 D. Anthropology focuses both on micro-social processes and big social structures
15. Violation of which cultural norm results repercussions ranging from excommunication to execution:
 A. Folkways
 B. Mores
 C. Dress code
 D. All
16. Shared guidelines that govern people's behavior in a certain circumstance are called —
 A. Norms
 B. Values
 C. Beliefs
 D. Symbols
17. Which concept related to cultural unity and variations describe the presence of features common to several but not all human groups?
 A. Universality
 B. Generality
 C. Particularity
 D. None
18. Cultural relativism can be expressed in its capacity to enable us to respect for cultural differences that *doesn't* involve —
 A. Appreciating cultural diversity
 B. Accepting and respecting other cultures
 C. Trying to understand every culture and its elements in terms of its own context and logic
 D. Accepting that each body of custom has worked out for every environment
19. A unidirectional flow of cultural aspects that cause culture change in the receiving society is —
 A. Acculturation
 B. Diffusion
 C. Enculturation
 D. All
20. Which sub-discipline of anthropology is most closely related to the natural sciences?
 A. Linguistic anthropology
 B. Physical anthropology
 C. Socio-cultural anthropology
 D. A and B

Part 4: fill in the blank space with appropriate answer (1 pt. each).

20. _____ is major perspective of anthropology that considers insiders' views as a primary focus of any anthropological inquiry.
1. _____ are material remains made and used by the past peoples and that can be removed from the site and taken to the laboratory for further analysis.
2. The belief that one's own culture and one's own way of life is superior to others cultural, social and material life is known as _____.
3. _____ refers to detail study of a given society and _____ refers to comparative study of diversified societies.

Answer Table

2.	3.	4.	5.
7.	8.	9.	10.
12.	13.	14.	15.
17.	18.	19.	20.
22.	23.	_____ and _____	

